REASONS FOR THE INCARNATION

Virgil Warren, PhD

Introduction

Knowing what heaven was like, why did Jesus ever leave it?
Knowing what earth was like, why did he ever come here?
Knowing what Golgotha was going to be like, why did Jesus ever become a man?

I. Communication: Hebrews **1**:1-2

A. Means of communication: "son" *vs*. angels/prophets
B. Manner of communication: demonstration and description

holistic	*vs*.	in many parts/progressive
"son-wise"		in many ways
personal		verbal

C. Message communicated: son *vs*. concepts

II. Representation: Hebrews **2**:5-9

A. Caretaker of creation
B. "Residency requirement"

III. Identification: Hebrews **2**:10-18

A. From birth through death
B. With the poor

IV. Replacement: Hebrews **10**:1-10; **9**:13-14

A. Cleansing from legal defilement via the blood of bulls and goats
B. Cleansing from defilement of conscience via the giving of the body of Messiah once and for all

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One way to teach is to give people an experience and ask them what they learned. In the incarnation God gave us an experience (event). What do we learn from it?

I. Our Worth

"I came that they might have <u>life</u> and have it abundantly" (John **10**:10).

A. Incarnation is based on the image of God in man (nature): <u>being</u> (Genesis **1**:26).
B. Incarnation expresses love (fellowship): <u>relationship</u> (John **3**:16).
C. Incarnation calls us back to our commissions (purpose): <u>action</u> (Hebrews **2**:6-10).

II. Our Attitude

> *"Make my joy full that you may be of the same <u>mind</u>, having the same love, being of one accord, of one <u>mind</u>, doing nothing through division or self-glorification, but in lowliness of <u>mind</u> each counting the other better than himself. . . . Have this <u>mind</u> in you that was also in Christ Jesus, who, existing in the form of deity, did not count being on an equality with God something to be clung to, but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men, and being found in fashion as a man, he humbled himself becoming obedient to death, yes, the death of the cross"* (Philippians **2**:2-8).

A. Humility

1. Willingness to accept limitation
2. Willingness to endure agony
3. Willingness to accept people

B. Unity among mankind: pride is the source of division between people.

III. Our Ministry

A. Identification
B. Timing for readiness: the timing of the incarnation (Galatians **4**:4 *"fullness of time"*; John **16**:12, *"You cannot bear them now")*
C. Salvation rather than criticism and condemnation (John **3**:17; **12**:47; Luke **19**:10)